

ISSUE 57

SEPTEMBER 13, 2026



LAST WEEK IN TÜRKİYE

A weekly roundup of the top news
and developments in Türkiye



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REMINDERS BY NUMBERS



since Ekrem Imamoglu was arrested.
The indictment seeks up to 2,430 years
in prison



since comedian Deniz Göktaş was
arrested. He remains in prison awaiting
trial over charges related to his stand-up
show. The court decided to release him,
re-arrested before leaving prison.



since Nasuh Mahruki, AKUT
rescue group founder, jailed in
pretrial detention on charges of
“inciting the public to hatred and
hostility on a post on X.



since elected Üsküdar Mayor Sinem
Dedetaş was jailed pending trial,
despite not being convicted of any
crime.



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STÜDYO RECAP



ÜSKÜDAR
BELEDİYESİ

ÜSKÜDAR FLIPS TO AKP AFTER FOURTH COUNCIL VOTE

Üsküdar became the ninth Istanbul district to shift from CHP to AKP control since the 2024 local elections, following the arrest and suspension of CHP Mayor Sinem Dedetaş. After a CHP acting mayor was initially elected, court challenges triggered repeated council votes. In the lead-up, several CHP district officials were detained or arrested as part of the municipal probe, while four CHP council members defected to the AKP, denying they had been threatened or offered incentives. On Sept. 8, AKP candidate Dündar Ziya Gültekin won a fourth-round vote.



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BIRGUN



OPPOSITION RALLIES IN ÜSKÜDAR AFTER AKP TAKEOVER

Üsküdar voters and opposition supporters rallied on Sept. 12 to protest the municipality's transfer from opposition to AKP control following the arrest of Mayor Sinem Dedetaş and a disputed series of council votes. A letter from the jailed mayor was read before Yeni Party leader Özgür Özel addressed the crowd, accusing the government of overriding voters' will through judicial pressure, arrests and council defections. He challenged President Erdoğan to hold a new election in Üsküdar, arguing that control of the district should be decided by voters.



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DEUTSCHE WELLE TR



LGBTQI+ RIGHTS GROUP KAOS GL RAIDED; ACTIVISTS DETAINED

Police detained at least 10 LGBTQ+ activists, including members of Kaos GL's management and supervisory boards, during coordinated operations across Türkiye on Sept. 13. Authorities said the broader "Ailem Güvende" ("My Family Is Safe") operation targeted 162 people, nine associations and 13 businesses across 15 provinces. Kaos GL is being investigated over alleged "obscenity" and association-law violations tied to online content. A day earlier, courts blocked access to websites and social media accounts of several LGBTQ+ organizations and activists in Türkiye.



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DEUTSCHE WELLE TR

A close-up portrait of Istanbul Mayor İmamoğlu, wearing glasses and a dark suit, with a red and white striped background.

İMAMOĞLU SENTENCED AFTER TWO PREVIOUS ACQUITTALS

An Istanbul court sentenced Istanbul Mayor İmamoğlu to two years and one month in prison for allegedly insulting former Tuzla Mayor Şadi Yazıcı during a 2022 speech. İmamoğlu was acquitted twice in the case, but both rulings were overturned on procedural grounds. The court also imposed a restriction on political rights that could amount to a political ban if the ruling becomes final. His lawyer said the decision will have no legal effect until the appeals process is exhausted and criticized the unusual course of the case, including a change of judge before the conviction.





FORMER DİYARBAKIR MAYOR RELEASED AFTER NEARLY SEVEN YEARS

Selçuk Mızraklı was released from prison on Sept. 8 after nearly seven years behind bars. Mızraklı was elected in 2019 with more than 62% of the vote, but was removed from office months later and replaced by a government-appointed trustee amid a terrorism investigation. Although Türkiye's top appeals court overturned the conviction in 2022 over insufficient reasoning, the same sentence was imposed after retrial and upheld in 2024.



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EVRENSEL



EZGİ APARTMENT CASE: TWO DEFENDANTS FREED AFTER SENTENCING

A court in Kahramanmaraş sentenced two bakery operators to six years and eight months in prison but ordered their release in the case over the collapse of Ezgi Apartment, where 35 people—including a six-month-old baby—were killed in the Feb. 6, 2023 earthquakes. Sami Kervancioğlu and Mustafa Pekel had been tried on charges alleging possible intent, while technical supervisor Mehmet Tekin received the same sentence. Three defendants were acquitted, and five municipal officials received four years and five months each. Relatives of those killed protested the verdict.



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DEUTSCHE WELLE TR

FORMER PM DAVUTOĞLU QUESTIONED OVER 2021 SPEECH

Former Prime Minister Davutoğlu gave testimony at an Ankara courthouse on Sept. 7 as a suspect in an investigation for allegedly “insulting the president” over remarks he made in 2021. The questioning lasted about 1.5 hours. Davutoğlu argued the investigation was politically motivated and intended to intimidate critics. He said he stood by his remarks criticizing the use of public resources, nepotism, favoritism, and corruption, describing them as political criticism protected by freedom of expression. He requested that prosecutors close the case without bringing charges.



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DEUTSCHE WELLE TR

A close-up photograph of Osman Kavala, a man with curly grey hair and a beard, wearing a dark suit and tie. He is speaking into a microphone, with his mouth open and eyes looking slightly to the side. The background is a blue wall with some text, including 'KAVANT' and 'TÜRK'.

KAVALA SEEKS RETRIAL FOLLOWING ECTHR RULING

Osman Kavala has asked an Istanbul court to reopen his Gezi Park case and order his release following a new ruling by the European Court of Human Rights. Kavala, imprisoned since 2017, was sentenced to aggravated life imprisonment in 2022. On Aug. 25, the ECtHR Grand Chamber found multiple rights violations and called on Türkiye to secure his release and eliminate the consequences of his conviction. Kavala's lawyers have now asked the Istanbul 13th High Criminal Court to suspend his sentence, order his release, and grant a retrial.



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EURONEWS



TURKIYE WINS SECOND CONSECUTIVE EUROPEAN VOLLEYBALL TITLE

Türkiye's women's national volleyball team, the "Sultans of the Net," defeated Italy 3–2 in Istanbul to win a second consecutive European Championship. After losing the first and third sets, Türkiye rallied to take the fourth 25–21 and the deciding set 15–10. The team had beaten Germany in the quarterfinals and Serbia in the semifinals, defending the European title it first won in 2023.

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